

Plate Tectonics and Earth's Structure

Earth's Layers:

1. Crust: Thin outer layer (5-70 km thick)
2. Mantle: Hot semi-solid rock (2,900 km thick)
3. Outer Core: Liquid iron and nickel (2,200 km thick)
4. Inner Core: Solid iron and nickel (1,200 km radius)

Plate Boundaries:

- Convergent: Plates move toward each other
- Divergent: Plates move apart
- Transform: Plates slide past each other

Evidence for Plate Tectonics:

- Continental fit
- Fossil distribution
- Seafloor spreading
- Magnetic striping